

“I call upon ... **Ho Chi Minh** to respond positively ... to this new **step toward peace.**”

PRESIDENT LYNDON B. JOHNSON, ADDRESSING THE NATION, MARCH 31, 1968.

» AFTER

Peace was not reached in 1968. The war would continue for five years—and see a new US president—before peace accords took the US out of Vietnam.

NIXON'S INFLUENCE

White House audio tapes, declassified and released in 2013, reveal a new take on why negotiations failed in 1968: Johnson discovered that Richard Nixon had been secretly (and illegally) **pressuring President Thieu** into backpedaling his support for the talks, by promising him a much better deal than Johnson, if and when **Nixon became president**—as he did later that year.